

(For the health professional)

Scoring and interpreting the DAST:

“Yes” responses receive one point each, **except for question #3, which receives one point for a “No” answer.** Points are added for a total score, which correlates with a zone of use that can be circled on the bottom right corner of the first page.

Score	Zone of use	Indicated action
0	I – No risk No risk of related health problems	None
1 - 2 , plus the following criteria: No daily use of any substance; no weekly use of drugs other than cannabis; no injection drug use in the past 3 months; not currently in treatment.	II – Risky Risk of health problems related to drug use.	Offer brief education on the benefits of abstaining from drug use. Monitor at future visits.
1 - 2 (without meeting criteria)		Brief intervention
3 - 5	III – Harmful Risk of health problems related to drug use and a possible mild or moderate substance use disorder.	Brief intervention (offer options that include treatment)
6+	IV – Severe Risk of health problems related to drug use and a possible moderate or severe substance use disorder.	

Brief education: Inform patients about low-risk consumption levels and the risks of excessive alcohol use.

Brief intervention: Patient-centered discussion that employs Motivational Interviewing concepts to raise an patient’s awareness of their substance use and enhances their motivation to change their use. Brief interventions are typically performed in 3-15 minutes, and should occur in the same session as the initial screening. Repeated sessions are more effective than a one-time intervention.

If a patient is ready to accept treatment, a referral is a proactive process that facilitates access to specialized care for individuals likely experiencing a substance use disorder. These patients are referred to alcohol and drug treatment experts for more definitive, in-depth assessment and, if warranted, treatment. However, treatment also includes prescribing medications for substance use disorder as part of the patient’s normal primary care.

More resources: www.sbirtoregon.org